

Board 2

South Deals

None Vul

♠ K J 4

♥ 10 5

♦ J 10 9 3 2

♣ Q 7 4

♠ 9 7 3

♥ K J 8 2

♦ A 8 4

♣ K 10 3



♠ A Q 10 2

♥ 6 4

♦ Q 7 5

♣ 9 8 6 2

♠ 8 6 5

♥ A Q 9 7 3

♦ K 6

♣ A J 5

West

North

East

South

Pass

3♥

Pass

4♥

All Pass

4♥ by South

Using elimination plays makes you a better player. But in Bridge, no matter how skillful you are, there will always be a luck factor.

Here you were lucky the defense didn't start by taking their three ♠s. If they had, you would not have been able to pull off the throw-in, and would have had to try your luck with guessing who had the ♣Q.

South is to play 4♥. West leads the ♦J.

With three unavoidable ♠ losers you cannot afford to lose a ♣. So you either have to guess the location of the ♣Q or (DRUMROLL) pull off an elimination play! Win the ♦K, then pull trumps, it takes two rounds.

Next you eliminate the ♦s by playing ♦A then ruffing the ♦8.

Execute the throw-in by leading a ♠.

The defense is in with a ♠ and they are welcome to take two more ♠s. But then they will have to play a ♠ or a ♦, giving you a ruff-sluff, or else lead a ♣ which finds the ♣Q for you.

Board 4

North Deals

None Vul

♠ J 3
 ♥ A 9 6 5
 ♦ J 10 8 7
 ♣ Q 8 5

♠ K 9 6 4

♥ Q 7

♦ K Q 6

♣ K J 10 3



♠ 10

♥ K J 8 3 2

♦ A 5 4 2

♣ 9 7 4

♠ A Q 8 7 5 2

♥ 10 4

♦ 9 3

♣ A 6 2

West	North	East	South
	1 ♣	Pass	1 ♠
Pass	2 ♠	Pass	4 ♠
All Pass			

4 ♠ by South

If East is the one who has to play a ♣ you just let it ride around to dummy's ♣ K J 10 3.

If West is the one who has to play a ♣ you need to insert the ♣10 or ♣J from dummy.

In either case you will no longer have a ♣ loser.

South is to play 4 ♠. West leads the ♦ J, covered by the ♦ Q and ♦ A. East returns a ♦ to the ♦ K.

You still have two losers in the ♥ suit, so the question is which way you plan to finesse the ♣s. And of course the answer is that you don't plan to finesse them at all!

Pull trumps with the ♠ A, then ♠ K. Next ruff dummy's last ♦.

Now exit with a ♥. The defenders win this and take another ♥ trick, leaving this position.

They must now break the ♣ suit for you or give you a ruff-sluff. Of course you would ruff in dummy and discard a ♣ from the 3-card holding in your hand.